

As seen in the table on the previous page, the Basic Edition lives up to the name: it's indeed quite basic. This point is made clearer as we take a look at the other features that define the Vista experience. Security is the cornerstone for Vista, unsurprisingly so; even the Basic variant retains the major security features. Only parental features are dropped in the business variants.

For the most part, the choice boils down to Vista Home Premium, Business, or Ultimate. Home Premium corresponds to where the Windows XP Media Center Edition is today, and offers some home theatre features in addition to the general feature set. Vista Business is similar to where Windows XP Professional is today (note that XP Pro does not offer high-end media solutions either). Windows Vista Ultimate is, of course, the version that has everything, and is a superset of the rest. Those who don't mind paying should definitely check out Vista Ultimate.

Upgrading				
Previous OS	Home Basic	Home Premium	Business	Ultimate
Windows XP Professional	Clean install	Clean install	In-place option available	In-place option available
Windows XP Home	In-place option available	In-place option available	In-place option available	In-place option available
Windows XP Media Center	Clean install	In-place option available	Clean install	In-place option available
Windows XP Tablet PC	Clean install	Clean install	In-place option available	In-place option available
Windows XP Professional X64	Clean install	Clean install	Clean install	Clean install
Windows 2000	Clean install	Clean install	Clean install	Clean install